

CAROLINA LOPEZ

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Personal Information:

Female, Salta-Argentina.

Graduate Studies:

M.A. in Economics, Universidad Nacional de La Plata, summa cum laude, 2012.

Ph.D. Student in Economics, Universidad Nacional de La Plata, 2012-2015.

Ph.D. in Economics, Brown University, 2015-2022.

Position:

2022-2023	Postdoctoral Research Fellow, Harvard Kennedy School
2023-	Research Economist, The World Bank's Development Research Group

Research Fields:

Primary fields: Development Economics, Economics of Education, Behavioral Economics

Secondary fields: Labor Economics

Publications:

"Exacerbated Inequalities: the Learning Loss from COVID-19 in Italy" (with Michela Carlana and Eliana La Ferrara), *AEA Papers and Proceedings*, vol. 113, pp. 489-493 (2023).

"Does Patient Demand Contribute to the Overuse of Prescription Drugs?" (with Anja Sautmann and Simone Schaner), *American Economic Journal: Applied Economics*, vol. 14, number 1, 225-260 (2022).

"Long-run effects of youth training programs: Experimental evidence from Argentina" (with María Laura Alzúa and Guillermo Cruces) *Economic Inquiry*, vol. 54, issue 4, pp. 1839-1859 (2016).

"Effect of a community-led sanitation intervention on child diarrhoea and child growth in rural Mali: A cluster randomized controlled trial" (with Amy Pickering, Habiba Djebbari, Massa Coulibaly, and Maria Laura Alzua). *The Lancet Global Health*, vol. 3, number 11, pp. 701-711 (2015).

"The long and winding road towards fiscal decentralization" (with María Laura Alzúa). *Económica – Universidad Nacional de La Plata*, vol. LX, pp. 3-43 (2014).

"Un Analisis Multidimensional de la Pobreza: Evidencia Reciente de las Regiones de Argentina" (with Romina Safojan). *Revista de Economía Política de Buenos Aires - Universidad de Buenos Aires (REPBA)*, 7, vol. 12, pp. 9-44 (2013).

Research Experience and Other Employment:

Fall, 2021	Brown University, Research Assistant for Professor Pedro Dal Bó
Summer, 2021	The World Bank, Consultant
Spring, 2019	Brown University, Research Assistant for Professor Pedro Dal Bó
Summer, 2017	Brown University, Research Assistant for Professor Anja Sautmann
Fall, 2016	Brown University, Research Assistant for Professor Anja Sautmann
Summer, 2015	The World Bank, Consultant
2011-2015	CEDLAS (Center for Distributive, Labor, and Social Studies) at Universidad Nacional de La Plata, Research Assistant and Junior Researcher

Professional Activities:

Presentations

Spring, 2024	LEER Conference (KU Leuven), RIDGE Public Economics (PUC Chile), Seminario de Investigación Instituto de Investigaciones Económicas (UNLP Argentina)
Fall, 2023	Congreso Internacional Ideice (Dominican Republic), Southern Economic Association, Workshop on Educational choices and transitions in secondary and higher education (PSE), Workshop on Economics of Education (UAndes Chile)

Spring, 2023	Pacific Conference for Development Economics (PacDev), Society of Labor Economics (SOLE)
Fall, 2022	Economics and Social Policy Seminar Series (Harvard University)
Spring, 2022	Economic Science Association, Association for Education Finance and Policy (AEFP)
Fall, 2021	Applied Microeconomics Lunch Seminar, Brown University; Department of Economics at Universidad Nacional de La Plata; Rising Scholars Conference Harvard Business School; LACEA RIDGE Job Market Showcase; Asociación Argentina de Economía Política at Universidad de Buenos Aires; NEUDC; Economic Science Association Job Market Seminar
Spring, 2021	Population Association of America, Washington
Fall, 2020	Applied Microeconomics Lunch Seminar, Brown University
Spring, 2020	Universidad Católica de Salta, Argentina; Applied Microeconomics Lunch Seminar, Brown University
Spring, 2019	Population Association of America, Austin
Fall, 2018	Applied Microeconomics Lunch Seminar, Brown University
Spring, 2017	Applied Microeconomics Lunch Seminar, Brown University
Spring, 2015	Canadian Economic Association, Ryerson University
* Scheduled	

Affiliations

2015-Present	Visiting Researcher, CEDLAS (Center for Distributive, Labor, and Social Studies) at Universidad Nacional de La Plata
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Referee

Oxford Development Studies, American Economic Review, Review of Economics and Statistics, Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization, Económica, World Bank Economic Review.

Honors, Scholarships, and Fellowships:

Fall-2021	George Borts' Prize in recognition of an outstanding Ph.D. dissertation. Department of Economics. Brown University.
2020-2021	Interdisciplinary Opportunities in the Humanities and Social Sciences, 2020-21. Population Studies and Training Center. Brown University.
Spring-2020	Merit Dissertation Fellowship. Department of Economics. Brown University.
2017-2018	Fellowship. Graduate Program in Development. Watson Institute for International and Public Affairs. Brown University.
2013-2015	Research Fellowship. Consejo Nacional de Investigaciones Científicas y Técnicas (CONICET). Buenos Aires, Argentina.
2013	Distinguished Graduate Award for the Highest GPA of the M.A. in Economics. Universidad Nacional de La Plata (UNLP). Buenos Aires, Argentina.
2012	Best Argentine Young Economist Award. Asociación Argentina de Economía Política (AAEP).
2012	Best grade in the class 2010. Master's Degree in Economics. Universidad Nacional de La Plata (UNLP).
2010	Scholarship. Master's Degree in Economics. Universidad Nacional de La Plata (UNLP).
2009-2012	Research Fellowship. Consejo de Investigación de la Universidad Nacional de Salta (CIUNSa).

Research Grants:

Fall 2022	Tinker Foundation
Summer-2021	Summer Funding, Graduate Program in Development. Watson Institute for International and Public Affairs, Brown University
Spring-2021	Bravo Center Award, Department of Economics, Brown University

Fall-2020	Bravo Center Award, Department of Economics, Brown University
Summer-2019	Award for Research Proposals on “Human capital formation and youth access to high-quality employment in Latin America” CAF-Development Bank of Latin America
Summer-2019	Summer Award to Promote Population Research Projects, Population Studies and Training Center, Brown University
Summer-2019	Summer Funding, Graduate Program in Development. Watson Institute for International and Public Affairs, Brown University
Spring-2018	Sarmiento Research Award for Latin American Studies. Center for Latin American and Caribbean Studies (CLACS), Brown University
Summer-2018	Summer Funding, Graduate Program in Development. Watson Institute for International and Public Affairs, Brown University
Summer-2018	Global Health Scholarship, Global Health Initiative, Brown University
2017	Graduate School International Travel Grant, Brown University (\$800); PSTC Travel Grant. Brown University

Research Papers:

“Tripping at the Finish Line: Experimental Evidence on the Role of Misperceptions on Secondary School Completion”

In many low- and middle-income countries, school completion rates remain low, even among students who have reached secondary school. In Argentina, for example, only half of the teenagers who reach the last year of secondary school complete the coursework necessary to receive a diploma. This paper evaluates a potential driver of this issue: the lack of information about both the probability of graduation and the labor market returns of finishing secondary school. An experiment conducted with senior high school students in Argentina tests the impact of providing information to students on efficiently allocating effort during their senior year and correcting beliefs about their chances of graduating. A second intervention provides information on the returns to education, serving as a benchmark. These interventions increased graduation rates by 10 and 20 percent, respectively, and college enrollment by 38 percent. Notably, improvements in graduation rates were larger for students with a lower initial probability of graduating. Addressing these information gaps in the last mile of secondary schooling has the potential to significantly improve educational outcomes.

“The Economics Performance of Native Groups in Argentina” with Pedro Dal Bó World Bank Policy Research Working Paper 10834.

This study uses individual-level census data from Argentina to examine the socioeconomic disparities between Native and non-Native people. Native people fare worse across a variety of indicators, including housing, education, employment, and health. On average, the observed disparities amount to 12 percent of the standard deviation and persist even after controlling for factors such as geographic location. Furthermore, there are differences in the intergenerational transmission of education between Natives and non-Natives: for each level of education of the parents, the children of Natives have, on average, fewer years of education than the children of non-Natives. Finally, the study also reveals large differences between Native groups: while some achieve average outcomes that surpass those of the non-Native population, others significantly lag behind. Notably, these differences are correlated with a characteristic of their pre-Columbian economy: the practice of agriculture.

“Do Patients Value High-Quality Medical Care? Experimental Evidence from Malaria Diagnosis and Treatment” with Anja Sautmann and Simone Schaner NBER Working Paper 32075 | World Bank Policy Research Working Paper 10746.

Can information about the value of diagnostic tests improve provider practice and help patients recognize higher quality of care? In a randomized experiment at public clinics in Mali, health providers and patients received tailored information about the importance of rapid diagnostic tests (RDTs) for malaria. The provider training increased provider reliance on RDTs, which improved the match between a patient's malaria status and treatment with antimalarials by 15-30 percent. Nonetheless, patients were significantly less satisfied with the care they received, driven by those whose prior beliefs did not match their true malaria status. The patient information intervention did not affect treatment outcomes or patient satisfaction and reduced malaria testing. These findings are consistent with highly persistent patient beliefs that translate into low demand for diagnostic testing and limit patients' ability to recognize improved quality of care.